

Financially Sovereign Academy

Correctional and Reentry Program

Budgeting & Emergency Savings

Facilitator Binder

Version 0.1 (provisional) · 2026-07-04

Provisional pilot-ready draft. External counsel review pending. Not for final facility distribution until legal/privacy feedback is reconciled.

Described as pilot-ready, never proven or validated. No outcome or recidivism claims.
Not legally approved. Source & Claims Ledger held at v0.2.

Module Brief: Budgeting & Emergency Savings (v0.2)

Program: Correctional and Reentry (build order #2 system-wide) Version: v0.2 (brief) | Date: 2026-07-02 | Status: Needs Dalia review (v0.1 was Approved; v0.2 adds the Ontology Spine per D-12, all other sections carried forward unchanged) Supersedes: budgeting-emergency-savings-brief-v0.1.md (kept as history) Sources: none cited in this brief; facts are design assumptions or flagged in Source Items Needed. No learner-facing numbers yet. Shape: 4 sessions x 90 minutes plus optional 5th capstone/review; each session standalone. Paper-first, nine-piece deliverable set.

0. Ontology Spine (D-12)

1. **What is this module really about beneath the surface?** Not category tracking. In this reentry module, budgeting is triage under pressure, income timing, obligation management, shock absorption, family pressure, and the creation of future options.
2. **Core concepts:** scarcity, triage order, the floor (planning to the worst week), income timing vs due dates, obligations (negotiable vs fixed), shock absorption, pressure (family, urgency, fear), true cost of fast money, backup moves, future options.
3. **Learner pressures connected to those concepts:** release-cash reality, supervision obligations, gratitude debt and guilt toward family, irregular income, fixed transitional-housing fees, no cheap credit access, shame about small numbers.
4. **System forces shaping choices:** fee extraction aimed at thin margins, predatory credit that appears exactly at shock moments, benefits timing gaps, documentation loops (ID needs the birth certificate), pay cycles that do not match billing cycles.
5. **Traps and incentives that distort good decisions:** fast money risks the thing that earns the money; silence feels safer than the early ask; visible cash invites claims; installments stack against irregular income; other people manufacture urgency.
6. **Shallow version to avoid:** “make a budget and stick to it.” Budgeting as spreadsheet discipline or personal virtue. A broken budget as personal failure.
7. **What the learner should see differently after:** most money crises here are timing-and-order problems under pressure, not character problems; an early phone call is a financial tool; the plan that matters is the one that survives the bad week.
8. **Concepts that repeat across scenarios:** triage order, the floor, the early ask, the backup move, true cost, protect-the-earner.
9. **Concepts that belong elsewhere and must not be over-taught here:** fee mechanics and accounts (Banking & Credit), collections rights / restitution / child support strategy (Debt module), scam anatomy (Scams module), paystub mechanics (Workforce).
10. **One-sentence ontology spine:** When money is short, the skill is slowing the damage, protecting the next step, asking early, and keeping one option open.

The learner should not leave thinking “I need a perfect budget.” The learner should leave thinking: “When money is short, I can slow the damage, protect the next step,

ask early, and keep one option open.”

1. Learner profile

Mixed room: people preparing for release (weeks to months out, no income now, working with estimates) and people recently released (roughly the first six months, working with real numbers). Recent money reality is commissary and trust accounts, where money was small, tracked by someone else, and spent in one place. Now money arrives small and irregular (gate money, family help, day labor, first paychecks) while obligations arrive fixed and stacked. Mixed literacy and numeracy. Some have never run a household; others ran one and lost it. Family may be managing their money. Works even without ID, phone, bank account, or job.

2. Real-world problem

In the first 90 days out, money in is irregular and money out is not: supervision costs, child support, phone, transport, housing contribution, work clothes. A budget built like a spreadsheet dies on contact with one bad week. One small shock (a bus pass, a tool, a fee) breaks the whole month, and the pressure moment that follows is exactly when the expensive options appear: payday loans, advances, informal borrowing, family conflict. This module teaches budgeting as **triage under pressure**, not category tracking, and savings as **a small shock absorber**, not a wealth plan.

3. Learning goals

Learners understand: how to decide what gets paid when everything cannot be paid; how to plan around irregular income instead of pretending it is steady; what actually counts as an emergency; why a small cushion changes their negotiating position with every trap; how family money pressure works and how to answer it without burning the relationship; why the most available money in a bad week is usually the most expensive.

4. What learners should be able to do by the end

Fill out a one-week money map on paper. Sort a stack of bill cards into “pay now / negotiate / later” and defend the order (stay housed, stay fed, stay legal, stay working). Make one plan that survives both a good week and a bad week. Write their own one-line definition of an emergency and use it on a sorting drill. Name a realistic first cushion rung for their situation, including “zero this week, with a date.” Deliver one practiced sentence in response to a family money ask. Pick the least expensive option from a set of realistic “fast money” offers and say why.

5. Common misconceptions

Budgeting means restriction and punishment. “I have too little money to budget” (triage matters most when money is smallest). An emergency fund does not count until it hits \$1,000 (illustrative threshold; the first \$25 changes outcomes). A budget that got broken once has failed. Pay whoever pressures loudest first. Supervision

fees and child support can wait until I am back on my feet (dangerous: consequences can include supervision problems; module teaches “ask early, in writing” and routes to the officer or free legal aid, never gives case advice). A credit card or loan can be my emergency fund.

6. Emotional barriers

Shame about small numbers and about looking at the numbers at all. Debt of gratitude: “they held me down while I was inside, I cannot say no.” Scarcity fatigue and present-bias after years when money was abstract. Pride that blocks asking for help or negotiating a bill. Fear that a plan is just another thing to fail at. A partner or relative who controls the money. Grief about lost years expressed as spending.

7. Likely scams, fees, traps, and pressure points

Payday and title loans at the exact moment of a shock. Paycheck-advance and cash-advance apps that look free. Rent-to-own pricing. Buy-here-pay-here car lots. Informal loans with social pressure attached. “Flip your gate money” hustles and fake investment offers targeting the recently released. Lending to family that is really giving. Cash cushions raided because they are visible at home. Prepaid card fee bleed and check-cashing costs (defined in Banking & Credit; appear here only inside decision scenarios). Phone and subscription plans that quietly eat the margin.

8. Paper-based activities

- **The Bill Stack.** Envelope of bill cards, not enough money; sort into pay now / negotiate / later under a time limit; compare orders in pairs.
- **Good Week / Bad Week.** Two income cards, one plan; the plan must survive both.
- **The \$60 Shock.** After the plan is made, a shock card lands mid-exercise. What moves? What must not move?
- **Emergency or Not?** Card sort: real emergency, expense that was coming anyway, pressure or urge dressed up as urgent.
- **The Family Ask.** Short role-play with scripted openers; one honest sentence that is not yes and not never.
- **Cushion Ladder.** Rungs from \$0 to one month of rent (labels illustrative); learner circles the realistic first rung and a date.
- **Fast Money Menu.** Realistic offers for the same \$250 need; rank by true cost; costs revealed after ranking.
- **First 30 Days of Spending.** Capstone map, dual-track. Feeds on the Banking & Credit 30-day setup plan (section 14).

9. Facilitator risks

Shame triggers when real numbers are tiny; never require sharing amounts aloud, worksheets stay private. Learners may disclose unpaid court obligations or supervision problems; facilitator redirects to officer or legal aid and does not advise (boundary script needed in the guide). Mixed room drift: dual-track worksheets keep both

engaged. The Family Ask role-play can surface real conflict; keep it script-based, not testimony. Facility rules may restrict discussing gate money amounts or envelope materials; implementation guide needs a materials variance note. Emotional flooding during the shock exercise; trauma-aware pacing, permission to step back to a fictional character card at any point.

10. Take-home / reentry action step

Pre-release: complete the first-week-out money map in estimates, plus a wallet-size card with their one-line emergency definition. Post-release: sort their real bill stack once this week and set the first cushion rung with a date, even if the rung is zero. Both: one sentence they will use the next time someone asks for money.

11. Source items needed

Topic	Source needed	Priority
Small-shock statistic (e.g. share of adults unable to cover a \$400 expense)	Federal Reserve SHED, current year, dated	High
Payday loan cost ranges	CFPB, dated	High
Supervision fee ranges	State-specific; jurisdiction-tag; possibly per-state insert sheet	High
Gate money amounts	State-specific; label carefully, verify; consider omitting exact figures	Medium
Cash-advance app fee structures	CFPB or dated review	Medium
Prepaid/check-cashing fees	Reuse Banking & Credit claim ledger; do not re-source	Medium

12. Assumptions made

Mixed pre-release and early post-release learners (per Dalia). Paper-first, no internet in class, facility-ready, pencil-only, black-and-white printable, no phones, no calculators required; all math simple enough by hand (D-10). 4 sessions x 90 minutes plus optional 5th capstone, each standalone-usable (D-10). Dual-track approved: shared worksheets where possible, pre-release uses estimates, post-release uses real numbers; separate variants only when a shared sheet would confuse (D-10). State-neutral module; state-specific items carry source-needed notes instead of figures (D-10). Banking & Credit is recommended before this module but this module must stand alone. Dollar figures in activities will be labeled illustrative until sourced.

13. Open questions (all 5 RESOLVED by Dalia 2026-07-02, logged as D-10)

1. Session count: 4 sessions + optional 5th capstone/review; each session standalone-usable.
2. States: state-neutral for now; source-needed notes for supervision fees, child support, wage garnishment, public benefits, legal aid, court obligations.
3. Materials: paper-first, pencil-only, black-and-white printable, no internet, no phones, no calculators required; hand-math only. Card sorts work as cut-or-fold single sheets.
4. Dual-track: approved; shared worksheets where possible, separate variants only when clarity requires.
5. Debt-module boundary: collections rights, debt validation, restitution strategy, child support modification, and court/legal strategy stay in the future Debt / Restitution / Child Support module. Here: budgeting impact, prioritization, and routing language only (“ask early, ask in writing, get help from the right office”).

14. Connection to Banking & Credit (without repeating it)

Clean seam: **Banking & Credit answers where money lives; this module answers where money goes.**

- B&C Week 6 produces the “30-day money setup plan” (open the account, direct deposit, credit actions, debt first-steps). This module’s capstone (First 30 Days of Spending) takes that setup as input and plans the flow through it. Cross-reference by name, never re-teach.
- Where to keep the cushion: one pointer to B&C’s account guidance (second-chance, Bank On). This module only adds the behavioral piece: visible cash gets raided, separate is safer.
- Predatory products: definitions and deep treatment live in B&C. Here they appear only as options inside decision scenarios (Fast Money Menu), with a “see Banking & Credit” pointer.
- Debt and collections: B&C covers first steps and rights pointers; the queued Debt/Restitution/Child Support module will go deep. This module strictly triages which obligation gets paid this week.
- Shared glossary terms (emergency fund, overdraft, payday loan) use the master glossary definitions verbatim.

Facilitator Guide: Budgeting & Emergency Savings (v0.2)

Program: Correctional and Reentry | Version: v0.2 (facilitator guide, post-audit) | Date: 2026-07-02 | Status: Needs Dalia review Supersedes v0.1 (kept as history). Applies all approved audit fixes; change list in end matter. Companion to the learner workbook, Sessions 1-4, all at v0.2 (approved). This guide runs the workbook as drafted; it does not rewrite learner pages. Written for a real instructor. Short sections, exact scripts, no theory.

1. Program purpose and boundaries

What this module teaches. How to decide where money goes when there is not enough of it: triage order, planning to the worst week (the floor), bridging predictable gaps, handling family and official money conversations, comparing fast-money options by true cost, and building an emergency plan that works at \$0. The learner leaves able to say: “When money is short, I can slow the damage, protect the next step, ask early, and keep one option open.”

What it does not teach. This module gives no legal advice, no tax advice, no investment advice, no credit repair advice, and no product recommendations. It does not rank supervision fees, child support, or court obligations against other bills. It does not re-teach banking, accounts, or fee mechanics (that is the Banking & Credit program). It does not promise outcomes of any kind.

Your one-line boundary as facilitator: you teach decisions and questions, never answers to legal or personal-case questions.

State-specific questions. Rules on supervision fees, child support, benefits, ID documents, and housing programs differ by state and change over time. You will be asked about them. The answer is always the same routing: the office that owns the rule, in writing, with a copy kept; free or low-cost legal aid for court-related questions where it is available. The routing is not a dodge. It is the correct skill and the thing you are teaching.

2. Facilitation principles

1. **Privacy first.** Worksheets are private, never collected, never read aloud by you or anyone else.
2. **Pass option, always.** Any learner can pass on any share-out with no explanation. Say it day one, honor it every time.
3. **Least harm is the frame.** Some pages have no good option on purpose. Name it before it happens (script 2), so a hard page reads as reality, not failure.
4. **No forced sharing, no public dollar amounts.** Discussions are about orders, reasons, and sentences, never amounts. If an amount slips out, do not repeat it, do not react to it.
5. **No shame language.** Financial trouble here is pressure and system design, not character. Never “you should have,” never “just.”

6. **Estimates are valid.** Pre-release learners use best guesses. Say so at every session opening; the workbook repeats it.
7. **Real numbers are optional.** Post-release learners may use real numbers privately; they never owe them to the room.
8. **You are not a counselor, lawyer, or case manager.** You hold the room, run the pages, and route the questions.

3. Session-by-session guide

Session 1: Where the Money Goes (90 min)

Goal: learners can triage a small amount of money for week one and survive a shock on paper. **Timing:** P1 opener 5 / P2-P3 S01 amount-card map 30 / P5-P6 S02 sequencing 30 / P7 shock drill 15 / P8 close 10. (The drill's printed "ten minutes silent" fits inside the 15; the group's must-not-move talk takes the rest.) **Materials:** workbook pages, pencils. Cards on P5 tear or fold; scissors not required. **Page-by-page:** - **P1:** read the ground rules aloud, all of them. Read the "no perfect answer" line twice (script 2 lives here). Set the pass option now (script 1). Keep it to five minutes; the pages carry the rest. - **P2:** silent work. Never ask who picked which card. If someone stalls on price guesses, offer wide spoken ranges; never write prices on the board. If someone says "I would not even have \$60": take it seriously, point to the "my real number" line, and do not linger. - **P3:** silent work, then optional pairs. Steer pair talk to the order, never amounts. The Card B block is the least-harm frame in action; do not soften it and do not dramatize it. - **P4:** read aloud while learners revise. Do not turn it into a lecture; it is four bullets. - **P5-P6:** read Denise's setup aloud; the birth-certificate catch teaches itself. If the room says "ID first," ask: "can she actually get the ID this week?" Silent sort, then pairs. The AFTER box is for after; say so once. - **P7:** the shock drill. Read the framing sentence in script (script 8 covers the medication card). Silent minutes first. Group discussion on ONE question only: what must not move. Watch for a learner currently living a shock; the page's own line ("if today IS the shock...") is your script. - **P8:** ninety seconds, done beats perfect. **Invite discussion:** P3 pair compare (orders), P6 pairs, P7 must-not-move. **Avoid discussion:** amounts anywhere; card choice on P2; medical details on P7. **Likely reactions:** relief at the \$60 card existing; frustration at the birth-certificate loop (that frustration is the lesson; let it breathe for one beat, then move to the sequencing fix). **De-escalation:** if the shock drill floods someone, quiet permission to stop writing and just listen; no attention drawn. **Standalone version:** works as-is; the opener carries everything needed.

Session 2: Plan to the Floor (90 min)

Goal: learners can bridge a predictable gap and find their floor from three uneven paychecks. **Timing:** P1 opener 5 / P2-P3 S03 gap timeline 25 / P4 S13 grid 25 / P5 read-aloud 10 / P6 S14 split 15 / P7 close 10. **Materials:** workbook, pencils. Optional board for the worked row. **Page-by-page:** - **P1:** read aloud, including the estimates line. If new learners are present, the first paragraph is their whole catch-up; do not re-teach Session 1. - **P2:** read both tracks aloud in the same neutral voice. Never ask who circled which track (housing status is private). If asked which

is worse: “Neither. A costs a hard conversation, B costs creativity.” The cousin quote gets read straight, no eyebrow. - **P3**: silent work. The “what is the real price of this offer?” line: give it a full quiet minute before anyone reads on. For Track B learners the least-harm paragraph is the page’s heart; read it aloud once for the whole room (it costs Track A nothing). Boundary questions about program fees: script 5. - **P4**: do Week 1 together on the board as the worked row; weeks 2 and 3 are individual. All numbers are round tens; if someone still stalls, pair them without comment. - **P5**: read aloud while learners check circles. The floor is \$20; let the “that sounds like bad news” turn land. - **P6**: silent split first, then pairs on reasons, never numbers. If someone starts describing a specific person taking their money: acknowledge, defer to Session 3 (“that page is coming, and it deserves its own time”). - **P7**: close. **Likely reactions**: the grid is where low-numeracy learners feel exposed; the worked row and round numbers exist for exactly that. Praise process, never speed. **De-escalation**: math shame shows up as jokes or shutdown; move to the pair without ceremony. **Standalone version**: works as-is; P1’s first paragraph is the recap.

Session 3: The Conversations (90 min), the heavy one

Goal: learners leave with two ready sentences: one for family, one for an office. **Timing**: P1 warm-up 10 / P2-P3 S04 35 / breather 5 / P4-P5 S16 30 / P6 close 10. **Materials**: identical slips of paper, a container, the pre-printed common-pressure slips (rent, family asking, court fee, phone, food, ride to work), pencils. **Page-by-page**: - **P1 warm-up**: run script 3 exactly. Block letters, pre-printed slips available to all, shuffle before reading, flat respectful voice, fold back anything identifying without comment. **Under 6 learners: pre-printed slips ONLY, no exceptions** (see section 7). - **P2**: read Keisha’s setup aloud, slowly. Then the framing line from the facilitator note: “This is Keisha’s page. Work it as Keisha. If it lands close to home, work it as yourself instead, on paper, privately.” - **P3**: learners write ONE row’s sentence. Role-play is optional pairs; passing counts; silent reading counts. Full-group fallback: you read both parts, the room critiques the sentence, never the person. - **Breather**: take it. Say the P4 line out loud: “Two hard conversations deserve a breath between them.” Stand, stretch, water. - **P4**: read aloud in full. This page holds the module’s most important boundary. Questions WILL come; script 4 and script 9, verbatim. - **P5**: silent work. The least-harm line above the order boxes gets read aloud once. Optional pairs practice the one sentence only. If a learner disclosed being behind: script 4’s second half, then move on without lingering on them. - **P6**: close gently, use the printed closing line. **Invite discussion**: warm-up sort; sentence critique (fallback mode); the office-sentence practice. **Avoid discussion**: anyone’s real family; anyone’s real case status; amounts. **Likely reactions**: this session produces tears more than any other, usually at P2-P3. Steady, unhurried, no spotlight. **De-escalation**: if someone needs to step out, let them, no follow-up in front of the room. Check in privately after if the facility allows. **Standalone version**: works as-is; P1 ground rules carry the frame. If running only this session, extend the warm-up debrief by five minutes; it builds the safety the other sessions would have built.

Session 4: Shocks, Traps, and the Plan (90 min)

Goal: learners can rank fast-money options by true cost and leave with a completed wallet card. **Timing:** P1 S07 spoken opener 20 / P2 S19 ranking 25 / P3 side-beat 5 (cut if long) / P4 S20 closer 25, protected / P5 module close 15 (includes the 60-second E/C/P sort). **Materials:** workbook, pencils. P4's wallet card tears out; scissors optional. **Page-by-page:** - **P1:** all spoken, no worksheet. Read Darius's Tuesday aloud, then run the three questions one option at a time. Do not let the room crown a winner; every option costs something (the facilitator note lists the costs). Curfew questions: script 6. - **P2:** silent ranking FIRST, then argument, then and only then open the AFTER box aloud. Script 7 keeps you off product-advice ground. Do not editorialize beyond the printed text. - **P3:** run it if time allows; if the session is long, cut this page, never P4. - **P4:** announce the protection: "This next page gets 25 minutes no matter what. It is the take-home of the whole course." Silent, quiet room. Line 4 (sell) is optional; never press. No first-call person: the community line is a full answer (say those words if needed). - **P5:** the E/C/P sort takes 60 seconds plus one minute of talk, from the wrap time. Then the definition line, action steps, land the ending with respect. If the capstone is scheduled, announce it; if not, this is the ending. **Likely reactions:** the menu page produces war stories ("I did the payday thing"). One story is useful; three is a detour. "That is exactly why this page exists" and move. **De-escalation:** rarely needed here; Session 4 is the most practical. Watch instead for checkout (someone done emotionally after Session 3); the wallet card usually pulls them back because it is concrete. **Standalone version:** works as-is; P1's recap line covers the course in one sentence. If this is the only session a facility runs, it is the best single session to run.

4. Required scripts (say these verbatim or close to it)

Script 1, opening privacy ground rule (every session): "Your worksheets are yours. I will never collect them, and nobody reads them but you. You can pass on any share-out, any time, no explanation. Writing it down is enough. And we never say dollar amounts out loud in this room, mine included."

Script 2, least-harm explanation (Session 1 P1, repeat whenever a page has no clean answer). Say it plainly, not brightly: "Some pages in this workbook have no perfect answer. That is on purpose, because some weeks have no perfect answer. When that happens, the goal is not the right answer. The goal is the least damage, and making the first call early. If a page feels impossible, the page is doing its job."

Script 3, pressure-pile warm-up (Session 3 P1): "Everyone takes one slip. Write one money pressure you know about, yours or anyone's. Three words is plenty. Print in plain block letters. No names, no amounts. If you would rather not write, take one of these printed slips instead and fold it; nobody can tell the difference. Fold it, drop it in. I will shuffle and read them out, and we will sort them together, and I read every slip the same way, no matter whose it is."

Script 4, S16 official-fee / supervision-fee boundary (Session 3 P4-P5): "I cannot tell you which bill to pay first when one of them is a court or supervision obligation. The rules are different in every state, so anyone answering that off the top of their

head is guessing, me included. What I can teach you is the move that is almost always better than silence: ask early, ask in writing, ask the office that owns the fee, and keep a copy. If it is court-related, free or low-cost legal aid, where it is available, is built for exactly this; the local sheet has the contact. Let's write your question down. That is your ask."

Script 5, S03 fixed-fee / halfway-house boundary (Session 2 P2-P3): "I do not know your program's rules, and this class cannot settle them. What it can do is sharpen your question: is there an office that can line the fee date up with your pay date, and can you ask it in writing? Ask the program office, keep the copy. That is the move."

Script 6, S07 curfew / supervision boundary (Session 4 P1): "Whether Darius could get permission for late travel is a real question, and it is not mine to answer. Conditions are different for everyone. The move is the same one from Session 3: ask the supervising officer, early, and in writing if you can. For this exercise, the curfew stands, which is what makes the choice hard."

Script 7, S19 fast-money menu without product advice (Session 4 P2): "I am not telling anyone to take an advance, take a loan, or pawn anything, and I am not promising any employer says yes. We are doing one thing: comparing what each option costs in total, and what each one risks that earns your money. You rank them. The judgment is yours; the two questions are the tool."

Script 8, medication-cost question routing (Session 1 P7, and whenever it recurs): "When coverage starts and how to restart it is different in every state and every program, so I will not guess at it. That question is exactly what the reentry office or your case manager is for. Write it down as your ask-early move. That is the play."

Script 9, when a learner asks for legal advice (any session): "That is a legal question, and you deserve a real answer to it, which means not mine. Legal aid can answer it where it is available. The office involved can answer it. I can help you write down the question so you walk in with it ready. That part I can do right now."

Script 10, when a learner says "I have no safe option" (any session). Pause first. Do not rush past what they said. Then: "Some weeks that is the truth, and pretending otherwise would insult you. So we go to least damage: protect the roof, the food, the legal stuff, and the thing that earns money, in whatever order your situation demands. Then the early call, because silence is the only move that always makes it worse. A backup move plus an early call is a real plan. You are not out of moves."

5. Boundary language: say this / do not say this

Legal obligations (general) | Say this | Do not say this | |—|—| | "Ask the office that owns it, in writing, and keep a copy." | "They can't do anything to you if..." / "You'll be fine if you skip it." | | "Free or low-cost legal aid may be available; check the local sheet." | Any prediction about violations, court outcomes, or consequences. |

Child support | Say this | Do not say this | |—|—| | "Support questions go to the child

support office or legal aid. Ask about your options early, in writing.” | “Pay it first.” / “It can wait.” / anything about modification, arrears strategy, or what judges do. | | “The early ask beats silence here too.” | “I have seen people just...” |

Supervision or court fees | Say this | Do not say this | |—|—| | “This workbook does not rank that bill, and neither do I. The move is the early written ask to the right office.” | “Always pay supervision first.” / “They rarely enforce that.” | | “When the stakes are high, guessing alone can make the damage worse.” | Your own state’s rule from memory, even if you are sure. |

Debt collectors | Say this | Do not say this | |—|—| | “You can ask for it in writing before anything else. The Banking & Credit take-home covers first steps, and legal aid covers the rest.” | “That debt is too old to matter.” / “Just settle.” / any rights interpretation. | | “The question for this class is only: does it jump this week’s line? Most people keep the roof and the food ahead of it. That is a budgeting choice, not legal advice.” | “Ignore them.” |

Housing program fees | Say this | Do not say this | |—|—| | “Ask the program office whether timing can move. In writing, keep the copy.” | “They have to work with you.” / “That fee isn’t legal.” |

Public benefits | Say this | Do not say this | |—|—| | “Eligibility and timing are state and program specific. The reentry office or case manager is the right door, and the question is worth writing down.” | Any eligibility guess, any timeline promise, any “you qualify.” |

Payday loans and cash-advance apps | Say this | Do not say this | |—|—| | “Compare total cost and what it risks that earns your money. The ranking is yours.” | “Never take one” as a rule / “This app is fine” / any product or brand endorsement. | | “The fee mechanics are covered in Banking & Credit.” | A re-teach of APRs and fee structures. |

Family money pressure | Say this | Do not say this | |—|—| | “A number and a date beat a maybe. ‘Not never, just not now’ is a real answer.” | “Your family is using you.” / “Just say no.” / any judgment of a learner’s family. | | “Every answer costs something. Pick the least damage you can live with.” | “The right answer is the partial.” |

6. Facility constraints

- **No internet, no phones, no calculators required.** Everything runs on paper and pencil; all math is single-step and round-tens.
- **Pencil-only safe.** No scissors required anywhere: every card “cuts or tears or just gets numbered.”
- **Black-and-white.** Nothing in the workbook depends on color.
- **Small room:** pairs become across-the-table partners; group sorts happen on one desk. For the Session 3 warm-up in small classes, remember the hard rule: **under 6 learners, pre-printed slips ONLY** (section 7).
- **Large room (15+):** split into tables of 4-5; warm-up slips still go into ONE pile (privacy improves with volume); you roam during silent work.
- **Mixed literacy:** read every setup aloud; run guidance pages (S1 P4, S2 P5) as read-alouds; worked row on the board for the grid; never call on anyone to read.

- **Non-writers:** pre-printed pressure slips (Session 3); scribe option offered privately, never announced (“want me to jot while you talk?”); verbal versions of reflection lines are full answers.
- **Pre-release track:** everything in estimates; action steps go with release papers; say the estimates line at every opener (it is printed there).
- **Post-release track:** real numbers, privately; action steps are this-week moves.
- **Time cuts:** if a session must shrink to 60 minutes, cut in this order: side-beats and AFTER-box discussion first, pair shares second. Never cut: Session 1 shock drill, Session 2 floor grid, Session 3 breather, Session 4 wallet card.

7. Risk notes: pages needing extra care

- **Session 2, S03 (P2-P3):** track choice reveals housing status; never poll the room. Program-fee questions pull you toward rule interpretation; script 5. The cousin’s offer can read as an insult to someone’s actual family; keep the reading neutral, the page criticizes the terms, not the cousin.
- **Session 3, pressure-pile warm-up (P1):** the highest privacy-mechanics burden in the course. Block letters, pre-printed slips, shuffle, flat voice, fold-back rule. **If the class is under 6, use ONLY pre-printed slips. No exceptions.** Tiny rooms defeat anonymity.
- **Session 3, S16 (P4-P5):** the module’s highest legal-drift risk. Scripts 4 and 9 verbatim. Never assess an individual’s risk, never rank the fee, never repeat a state rule from memory.
- **Session 4, S07 (P1):** curfew detail invites supervision-condition talk; route with script 6 and keep the exercise on the three questions.
- **Session 4, S19 (P2):** product-advice risk; script 7, and read the AFTER box as printed, no additions. War stories: one is teaching, three is a detour.
- **Medication-cost shock card (Session 1 P7):** medical privacy plus benefits routing in one card. Script 8; never let group talk touch anyone’s actual medications or diagnoses.

8. End matter

Facilitator guide page list (for the formatted version)

1. Purpose and boundaries (section 1)
2. Facilitation principles (section 2)
3. Session 1 run sheet
4. Session 2 run sheet
5. Session 3 run sheet
6. Session 4 run sheet
7. Scripts card (scripts 1-10, designed to print as a two-sided quick card)
8. Say / do-not-say tables
9. Facility constraints and adjustments
10. Risk pages one-glance list

Estimated formatted length: 10-14 pages.

v0.1 → v0.2 change list (all approved audit fixes)

1. Script 4: trust-theater line replaced with “The rules are different in every state, so anyone answering that off the top of their head is guessing, me included.”; legal-aid clause softened to availability-honest wording.
2. Script 10: kept “You are not out of moves.”; added delivery cue “Pause first. Do not rush past what they said.”
3. Under-6 rule hardened: “use ONLY pre-printed slips. No exceptions.” in section 7, in the Session 3 run sheet, and cross-referenced in section 6 small-room bullet.
4. Script 3: untraceable-slip promise replaced with “and I read every slip the same way, no matter whose it is.”
5. Legal-obligations table: “Free or low-cost legal aid may be available; check the local sheet.”
6. Debt-collector table: “Most people keep the roof and the food ahead of it. That is a budgeting choice, not legal advice.”
7. Session 3 heading: em dash replaced with a comma. (File now contains zero em dashes.)
8. Session 1 timing restated: 5 / 30 / 30 / 15 / 10; “folded into the drill” phrasing removed; drill note explains the fit.
9. Session 2 floor grid added to the 60-minute never-cut list.
10. Script 5: “this class cannot settle them. What it can do is sharpen your question.”
11. Script 8: closer trimmed to “That is the play.”
12. Low fixes: Session 1 P2 note now gives the actual move (“take it seriously, point to the ‘my real number’ line, and do not linger”); script 2 delivery cue added (“say it plainly, not brightly”); section 1 routing line updated to availability-honest legal-aid wording.

Unresolved risks

- ~~The optional capstone session has no run sheet yet.~~ **Resolved 2026-07-03:** the capstone exists as “The First 30 Days” (budgeting-emergency-savings-capstone-v0.2.md, content + run sheet, three delivery modes). Any earlier capstone sketch (recap cards + S17 + bench scenarios) is superseded by that design; S17 stays benched as a future asset per Dalia.
- Scripts are revised, not yet legally reviewed; the v0.5 pass reads scripts 4, 5, 6, 8, 9 and every say/do-not-say table.
- The under-6 pre-printed-slips rule should still be validated with a real facilitator before pilot.
- Facilitator check-in after a learner steps out (Session 3 note) depends on facility rules; the implementation guide owns that policy.
- No pre/post assessment exists yet (separate deliverable in the nine-piece set).

Source-needed list

Item	Source needed	Priority
Legal aid referral (availability-honest phrasing now used)	Local/state legal aid directories per facility insert; national fallback (e.g. LSC directory), dated	High
Community help line reference (S20, medication routing)	Local 211-equivalent per facility insert; keep guide text generic	High
Benefits reactivation phrasing (script 8 stays generic)	If any state insert is ever written: current official state sources + legal review	High
Payday/app/pawn/title cost shapes (S19 AFTER box)	CFPB or equivalent, dated, before any figure is printed	High
Bank On / second-chance pointer accuracy (B&C cross-reference)	Reuse Banking & Credit claim ledger; verify still current at source-review stage	Medium